

SIX MATCH-WINNERS WHO DROVE INDIA'S TITLE CHARGE

India secured its third Champions Trophy title with an unbeaten run. Here are the main architects of that win.

Abhishek Saini
abhishek.s@thehindu.co.in

Rohit Sharma

Rohit set the tone once again at an ICC tournament with his aggressive approach at the top. Though he scored 180 runs in five innings, his strike rate of 100 stood out — only three batters tallied more runs at a higher rate.

His signature pull shot fetched 44 runs off just 15 balls. In the final, his 41-ball fifty powered India to 64 inside the PowerPlay, setting up a 104-run stand with Shubman Gill.

"It's not natural to me, but I wanted to try something different. The team backed me, and it paid off," Rohit reflected.



44

Runs from pull shots off just 15 balls

Virat Kohli

Virat Kohli's mastery in ODI chases was on full display in the Champions Trophy. He struck a century against Pakistan in the group stage and played a crucial 98-ball 84 in the semifinal, guiding India to its highest run chase (265) in Dubai.

On spin-friendly pitches, Kohli relied on singles to keep the scoreboard ticking. Against Australia, he scored 60 off 65 balls in the middle overs, with 48 runs coming through running. Against Pakistan, he picked 23 singles against spinners in this phase.

With 218 runs in this edition, Kohli became the second-highest run-scorer in Champions Trophy history, behind Chris Gayle. He also joined Sachin Tendulkar and Kumar Sangakkara in the elite 14,000-run ODI club, reaching the milestone in just 287 innings — the fastest ever, surpassing Tendulkar's record.



100

Remained unbeaten in a crucial run chase against arch-rival Pakistan